No government in the past thirty years, since the economic policy reforms began in 1991–92, has seen such a bad first half of a five-year tenure. The Narasimha Rao government produced gross national income growth of 1.0 per cent, 5.5 per cent and 4.9 per cent in its first three years from 1991 to 94. The coalition governments also produced a gross national income growth rate of 7.7 per cent and 4.2 per cent from 1996 to 1998. The Atal Bihari Vajpayee-led NDA government turned out gross national income growth of 6.2 per cent, 8.8 per cent and 3.6 per cent in the first three years of 1998–2001. Growth in the first three years of the UPA government (2004–2007) was a roaring high of 7.9 per cent, 9.3 per cent and 10.2 per cent. The first three years (2009–2011) of UPA-II also saw high growth of 8.5 per cent, 9.8 per cent and 6.9 per cent.

Indeed, the GDP growth rate of 1.5/2 per cent in the first three years of this NDA government's second term becomes a total washout if seen from the perspective of per-capita income growth when adjusted for population growth during the period.

Indian Economy Has Been Functioning Poorly Since 2019–20

2019–20: A Disappointing Year for the Economy

Indian GDP growth was in free fall since the March 2018 quarter, from a peak of 8.1 per cent in the fourth quarter of 2017–18 to 3.1 per cent in the fourth quarter of 2019–20. The Indian economy registered GDP growth of only 4 per cent in 2019–20—the slowest since 1991 in the post-reforms economic era. GDP was expected to touch Rs 225 trillion at the end of 2019–20, which at Rs 75 to a dollar was tantalizingly close to making India a $3 trillion economy. Instead, GDP at current prices turned out to be only Rs 203 trillion, making the Indian economy about $2.7 trillion.

Dark clouds had started covering the horizon from the second quarter itself when GDP growth in real terms slipped to a decade low of 4.5 per